

Multi-Platform Catalog Systems Remediation

Luxury Jewelry & Home Retail | Shopify, POS Integration & Product Data Architecture

ROLE: DIGITAL STRATEGIST, SOLO ENGAGEMENT | FOUR-WEEK SYSTEMS REMEDIATION

THE ENGAGEMENT

A luxury multi-brand retailer had spent years trying to launch e-commerce across three unsynchronized systems: WordPress, Lightspeed X-Series, and Shopify. The engagement began as catalog remediation but quickly became a systems diagnosis: product identity, import logic, image hosting, taxonomy, and launch readiness all had to be rebuilt as one operating model.

24/100

MOBILE LIGHTHOUSE BASELINE

3

PLATFORMS WITHOUT SOURCE OF TRUTH

989 -> 12K

CATALOG SCOPE REFRAME

1 day

DIRECTORY BLOCKAGE DIAGNOSED

INHERITED STATE

- Legacy WordPress site scheduled for retirement
- Unpublished Shopify storefront
- Lightspeed POS/inventory system of record
- No reliable pipeline for product data, images, SEO, or tags
- Mobile performance and layout stability below launch standard

WHAT CHANGED

- Reframed the problem from content cleanup to systems architecture
- Identified a structural import defect causing silent product loss
- Built a pre-import protocol and two-pass catalog pipeline
- Prioritized high-value brand passes inside a realistic four-week scope

CONFIDENTIALITY NOTE

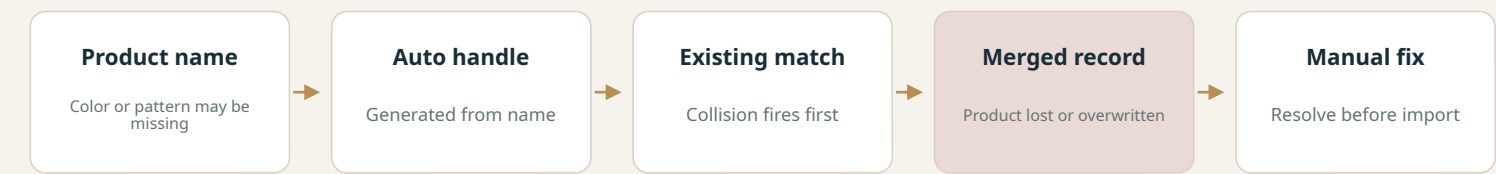
Client, brand, and individual names are anonymized. Visuals are recreated; no private admin views, customer data, proprietary spreadsheets, logos, or product photography are shown.

The handle-collision problem

The key finding was not a data-entry issue. It was a product-identity matching defect that could silently merge or overwrite products during import.

MECHANISM

The POS import process matched incoming rows against existing product handles generated from the product name. When two products produced the same handle, the second record could be treated as a duplicate of the first before name corrections were applied.



SEVEN-STEP PREVENTION PROTOCOL

- Generate handles in the working spreadsheet
- Verify distinguishing attributes in product names
- Deduplicate within the batch
- Check supplier-code uniqueness
- Cross-check against the existing catalog
- Standardize tag delimiters before sync
- Resolve collisions manually before import

IMPACT OF DISCOVERY

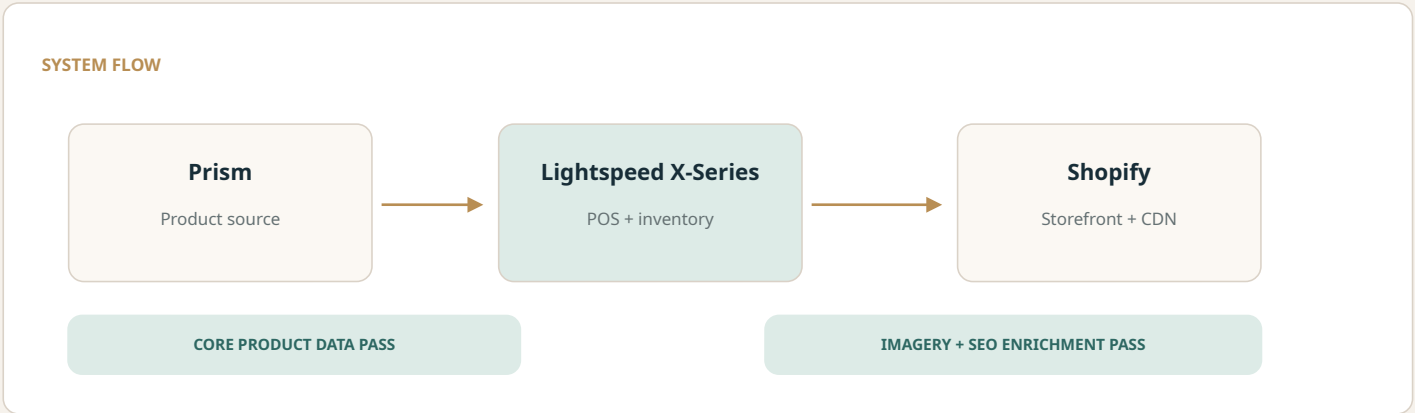
The fix turned recurring product attrition into a preventable pre-import QA step, eliminating further collision-driven data loss across subsequent brand passes.

IMPORTANT CONSTRAINT

A corrective CSV could not repair an existing collision because the handle match occurred before the name correction. Existing collisions required manual remediation first.

A two-pass pipeline for launch readiness

The rebuild separated inventory data from storefront enrichment so each platform could receive the fields it could actually support.



PASS 1: POS / INVENTORY

- Product names and distinguishing attributes
- Pricing, category, and supplier data
- Brand-specific tag taxonomies
- Handle checks before import
- Inventory sync verification

PASS 2: SHOPIFY / STOREFRONT

- Image URLs re-hosted through Shopify CDN
- Alt text and SEO fields
- Storefront presentation cleanup
- Product pages as separate records when required
- Legacy image-hosting risk reduced

IMAGERY-GAP TRIAGE

Isolate existing photo	Generate pattern/color	Apply swatch
Use usable vendor/source photography when available	Create AI-assisted placeholder only where brand fit allowed	Hold catalog space when no product image could be sourced

13	2,700+	20	271
BRANDS PROCESSED	SKUS AUDITED + CLEANED	RECORDS RECREATED	UNAVAILABLE ITEMS FLAGGED

What the engagement produced

The public case study emphasizes verified operational outputs, not current-site performance that remained under agency control after the engagement.

DOCUMENTED OUTCOMES

TRUE SCOPE	Reframed catalog from a reported 989 products to roughly 12,000 active products.	DATA LOSS FIX	Identified handle collisions and created a repeatable prevention protocol.
CATALOG PIPELINE	Built a two-pass Lightspeed-to-Shopify workflow for data, imagery, SEO, and CDN hosting.	REVENUE PROTECTION	Flagged discontinued-but-stocked products for sell-through instead of removal.

VALIDATED INNOVATION PROTOTYPE

AI-assisted photography pipeline

A pattern-swap imaging workflow was validated end to end, with estimated generation costs of roughly \$0.03 per image. It produced catalog-ready output, but was not deployed for the initial artisan brand because AI imagery did not fit that brand positioning.

VALIDATED, NOT OVERCLAIMED

EVIDENCE BOUNDARY

- Baseline performance documented; no final score claimed without post-remediation proof
- Client and brand names anonymized
- No private dashboards, admin views, or product images shown
- Open items clearly separated from completed work

CAPABILITIES DEMONSTRATED

Systems diagnosis | Product data architecture | POS-to-Shopify integration | CSV import governance | Catalog taxonomy | AI workflow validation

Public positioning A four-week systems remediation that turned a stalled e-commerce launch into a documented catalog operating model by diagnosing root causes, rebuilding import governance, and creating repeatable product-data workflows.